02-23 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Do Pets Really Help Children Grow Up?

① In city living rooms across China, small animals are becoming common family members. Cats sleep on sofas, dogs wait by the door, and even rabbits hop around in corners. Many parents now ask a serious question: **Do pets really help children grow up, or do they just add noise and trouble to a busy home?**

② Some parents are clearly against pets. They worry that feeding, bathing and cleaning will eat up the child's study time. A dog may bark when guests arrive, a cat may knock books off the desk, and both may bring hair onto clothes and beds. "My daughter is preparing for the senior high entrance exam," one mother said. "A new pet is the last thing we need."

③ Yet these practical worries miss the deeper point. Looking after a pet is, in fact, a child's **first small job**. A pet cannot speak, so a child must pay careful attention — is the water fresh? Is the cage clean? Does the dog need a walk? These tiny daily duties quietly build **a sense of responsibility**, a quality that no textbook can deliver in a single lesson.

④ A pet is also a patient friend. When a child is nervous before an exam, a soft cat on the lap can calm his beating heart in a way that words cannot. Research from a children's hospital in Shanghai in 2024 found that children with a gentle pet at home had **lower anxiety levels** than children without pets, especially during exam weeks. The pet does not solve a math problem, but it lowers the tired shoulder.

⑤ Pets also teach **kindness to other lives**. A child who once gently held a small rabbit, or waited at 3 a.m. for a sick kitten at the animal hospital, will find it harder to be cruel to another living thing. Such feelings of care, once planted early, often grow into respect for nature, for elderly people, and even for small neighbors in the street.

⑥ Of course, not every family should keep a pet. Crowded houses, serious allergies or long working hours may make pet care hard. When the conditions are not right, choosing not to have a pet is also a kind decision. For families that can keep one, however, pets are not just a source of noise — they are a quiet teacher who walks on four soft paws, showing our children how to be patient, kind and truly grown-up.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why do some parents dislike having pets at home?

A. Because pets are too expensive.
B. Because pets may take up study time and cause some trouble.
C. Because pets refuse to eat human food.
D. Because pets are against traditional Chinese culture.

2. What is the "first small job" for a child, according to Paragraph 3?

A. Learning a foreign language.
B. Looking after a pet.
C. Doing daily math problems.
D. Washing the car.

3. What did the 2024 research in Shanghai find?

A. Children with pets had lower anxiety levels during exam weeks.
B. Pets could solve math problems for children.
C. Children with pets got full marks in all subjects.
D. Pets made children sleep less at night.

4. Why does the writer think pets teach kindness?

A. Because pets can talk with children.
B. Because caring for a pet makes children respect all living things.
C. Because pets always obey every order.
D. Because pets earn money for the family.

5. What is the writer's final view?

A. All families must keep a pet.
B. Pets are a quiet teacher for those families that can keep one.
C. Pets are only useful for rich families.
D. Pets are harmful and should be banned.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段关注点
【解析】家长担心宠物占学习时间并带来麻烦。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题

【定位】第③段 "first small job"
【解析】照顾宠物即第一份小工作。故选 B。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "lower anxiety levels"
【解析】养宠物者考前焦虑较低。故选 A。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑤段 "harder to be cruel to another living thing"
【解析】养宠物培养对生命的尊重。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】观点态度题
【定位】第⑥段末句
【解析】适合的家庭里，宠物是温柔的老师。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **responsibility** [n.] 责任感
- **anxiety** [n.] 焦虑
- **allergy** [n.] 过敏